A-A-20174
June 29, 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

COCONUT, DRIED, PREPARED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Type I, Style 4 and Type II, Style 3 of Federal Specification Z-C-571.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers dried, prepared coconut, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The dried, prepared coconut shall conform to the following types as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Sweetened, flake
Type II - Unsweetened, extra fine

Type I shall be sweetened flakes and shall contain not less than 57 percent by weight of coconut solids, not more than 17 percent by weight of moisture, and not less than 2 percent by weight of propylene glycol. When used as optional ingredients, not more than 1 percent glycerol monostearate, not more than 8 percent glycerol, not more than 3.5 percent sorbitol, and not more than 1 percent salt shall be added by weight. The finished product shall possess a characteristic flavor, texture, odor, and color typical of high quality coconut. The coconut shall be salmonella negative and staphylococcus (coagulase positive) negative. Not less than 90 percent by weight of the flake coconut shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 4 sieve and be retained on a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve.

Type II shall be unsweetened, extra fine coconut and shall contain not less than 96 percent by weight of coconut solids and not more than 4 percent by weight of moisture. Propylene glycol may be added at levels not less than 2 percent by weight. The finished product shall possess a characteristic flavor, texture, odor, and color typical of high quality coconut. The coconut shall have a free fatty acids content of not more than 0.15 percent (as oleic) and a pH of 6.0 or higher. The coconut shall be salmonella negative and staphylococcus (coagulase positive) negative. One hundred percent by weight of the extra fine coconut shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 12 sieve and no less than 30 percent by weight shall be retained on a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

FSC 8925

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Analytical requirements.

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the latest edition of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC) or the Official and Tentative Methods of the American Oil Chemists' Society, as applicable:

Test	Chapter and Section	Method
	AOAC	
Propylene Glycol	Chapter: Drugs, General	Propylene Glycol in Drugs
Coconut Solids 1/	Chapter: Nuts and Nut Products	Fat (Crude), Gravimetric Methods
Moisture 2/	Chapter: Sugars and Sugar Products Section: Sugars and Sirups	Vacuum Drying
Salmonella	Chapter: Microbiological Methods	Flourescent Antibody Screening Method
Staphylococcus	Chapter: Microbiological Methods	Surface Plating Method for Isolation and Enumeration
Salt	Chapter: Nuts and Nut Products	Sodium Chloride, Titrametric Method
pH	Chapter: Cereal Foods Section: Wheat Flour	Hydrogen-Ion Concentration, Potentiometric Method
Free Fatty Acids	Official and Tentative Methods of the American Oil Chemists' Society Section: Commercial Fats and Oils 3/	Ca Sa -40

1/ The percent coconut solids shall be calculated from percent total fat using the following formula: Percent coconut solids = $\frac{\text{Percent extracted fat}}{0.673}$

2/ Total moisture shall be expressed as percent total volatiles minus the percent of propylene glycol.

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3/ Official and Tentative Methods of the American Oil Chemists' Society, Section C: Commercial Fats and Oils. Sample preparation shall be as follows: Place 100 grams of sample, 25 grams anhydrous sodium sulfate, and 250 milliliters petroleum ether in a blender cup. Seal and blend (using an explosion proof blender motor) 3 minutes at high speed. Filter through rapid paper and collect 150 milliliters clear filtrate. Transfer 25 milliliters of filtrate to a tared 125 milliliter Erlenmeyer flask and 100 milliliters to a 250 milliliter Erlenmeyer flask. Evaporate solvent from the 25 milliliter aliquot, dry to constant weight at 100°C, and determine weight of fat. Four times this weight of fat in 100 milliliter filtrate shall be used for free fatty acids analysis. Evaporate off most of the petroleum ether from the 100 milliliter filtrate and proceed as in Ca Sa -40.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, will visually determine the quality of the dried, prepared coconut according to PPB procedures, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers. The product shall be chemically analyzed in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID by the Commodities Scientific Support Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The dried, prepared coconut shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. Seven ounces of product shall be packaged in a 300 x 508 can or nineteen ounces of product shall be packaged in a 404 x 700 can. The cans shall be hermetically sealed. Alternatively, 5 or 25 pounds of product shall be packaged in bags in accordance with good commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. Twelve 300 x 508 or 404 x 700 cans or one 5-pound bag shall be packed in a fiberboard box. Twenty 25-pound bags shall be palletized and bonded with shrink or stretch film in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

C. Export packaging. Seven ounces of product shall be packaged in a 300 x 508 can or nineteen ounces of product shall be packaged in a 404 x 700 can. The can shall be an open-top, tinplated, metal can with welded or soldered side seams and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate. The interior of the bodies and ends shall be enameled and the inside seam striped. The base plate weight and temper shall be sufficient to protect the product during shipment and storage. Cans shall be coated on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I or II, or when specified, Type III of TT-C-495. The cans shall be hermetically sealed. Five or twenty-five pounds of product shall be packaged in moisture vaporproof bags.

D. Export packing. Twelve 300 x 508 cans, twelve 404 x 700 cans, or one 5-pound bag shall be packed in a snug-fitting, fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s, Style RSC of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape. Twenty 25-pound bags shall be palletized and bonded with shrink or stretch film in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-30578. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

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F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

G. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

The purchaser must specify the type of coconut and the size of the container required.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
1111 North 19th Street
Suite 210
Arlington, VA 22209

Copies of the Official and Tentative Methods of the American Oil Chemists' Society may be purchased from:

American Oil Chemists' Society
508 South Sixth Street
Champaign, IL 61820

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Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (Master Charge or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairman
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to:

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

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